

PM SCHOOL

XLRI Case Study Challenge

The problem statement -

LinkedIn wants to eat Facebook, WhatsApp, Instagram and Twitter's lunch in terms of getting people to spend more time on LinkedIn and have higher engagement there. Research shows that the total amount of time a user will spend on these 5 platforms is fixed and hence the only way LinkedIn can increase engagement and time spent on their platform is by eating into the amount of time people spend in these 4 other platforms.

Questions -

1. If you were the Head of Products at LinkedIn, how would you have approached this problem?
2. What all engagement levers or products would you have built in LinkedIn and why?
3. Please define your hypotheses and then come up with an interaction design (wireframes) showing what the new LinkedIn should be
4. If you had to articulate how much improvement will happen in engagement and retention numbers due to these additions/changes how will you arrive at those numbers and what does those numbers look like given your plan described in step 3 above
5. Write user stories for the most important product/features that you have articulated in your wireframes in step 3

Please make suitable assumptions and convert this high-level business problem into product decisions and then come up with design considerations eventually leading to wireframes and user stories.

Note - You will obviously have to focus on 'why' people spend 'lesser' time on LinkedIn and hence what does it take to increase that time/engagement by eating away the time people spend on F, W, T, I. But you will also be evaluated on 'what' you are suggesting and your ability to convert business needs to product requirements and then translating that to design concepts + user stories which can be implemented.

Please note that the problem quoted is completely hypothetical in nature. Please submit your attempt in not more than 10-12 slides in PDF format only. Please use the naming convention - "TeamName.pdf"

Beer and Brain – First Year



DHANANJAI



KERFEGAR DALAL

Primary and
Secondary
Research

User Personas

Approach to
problem

Features

User stories

Prioritization of
features



High awareness

Low Offerings



MONSTER



High Offerings



Low awareness



760M+

Users across the globe

200+

Countries

260M+

MAU

17mins

Average
daily usage

30M+

Companies

Few Insights for Audience on LinkedIn

- 17 million opinion leaders and 10 million c-suite executives are there in LinkedIn
- 38% of the LinkedIn users are millennials
- 39% percent users use LinkedIn premium



57% - 43%



Surveys

- 105 people from age range 20-60 from Tier 1,2,3 cities were reached out
- Student, professors, Working class people were surveyed



Interviews

- Product managers – 10+ from multiple companies
- LinkedIn Users – 20+ users from multiple employments



Stakeholder Ramification



- 40% of LinkedIn users use LinkedIn to change job every 4 years
- LinkedIn is no more just a job postings platform, content impressions is 15x times the job postings currently
- There has been growing trend to search for Work from Home jobs on LinkedIn after covid related layoffs and subsequent job searches

KEY Growth drivers



- Increasing internet penetration across the globe
- LinkedIn Live streams grew by 437% in 2020
- Content creation increased by 60% on LinkedIn since 2020
- Growing Freelance Community provides an additional avenue
- Remote jobs increased by 2.5x on LinkedIn after October 2020 when worldwide lockdown was at it's peak

Frequent Searches

Hashtags: #Networking, #Workfromhome, #Homeoffice, #workingathome
Keywords: LinkedIn Jobs, Jobs, Work from home jobs, Job search



Why do people use LinkedIn?



- 60% of users use LinkedIn for industry updates
- Less than 9% percent of users have less than high school degree on LinkedIn
- Employees share their firm's content 14x than other content
- 73% social media users feel LinkedIn protects their data
- LinkedIn ads have more than 200 targeting characteristics giving you maximum opportunity to get the attention of TG
- Companies using LinkedIn get 2x engagement rate when compared to others

Usage by Device Type

- ANDROID – 25%
- DESKTOP/WEB – 36%
- IOS – 24%
- OTHERS - 15%

Sentiment Analysis of LinkedIn Users reviews

91.84

Sentiment
score

27%



2%



71%





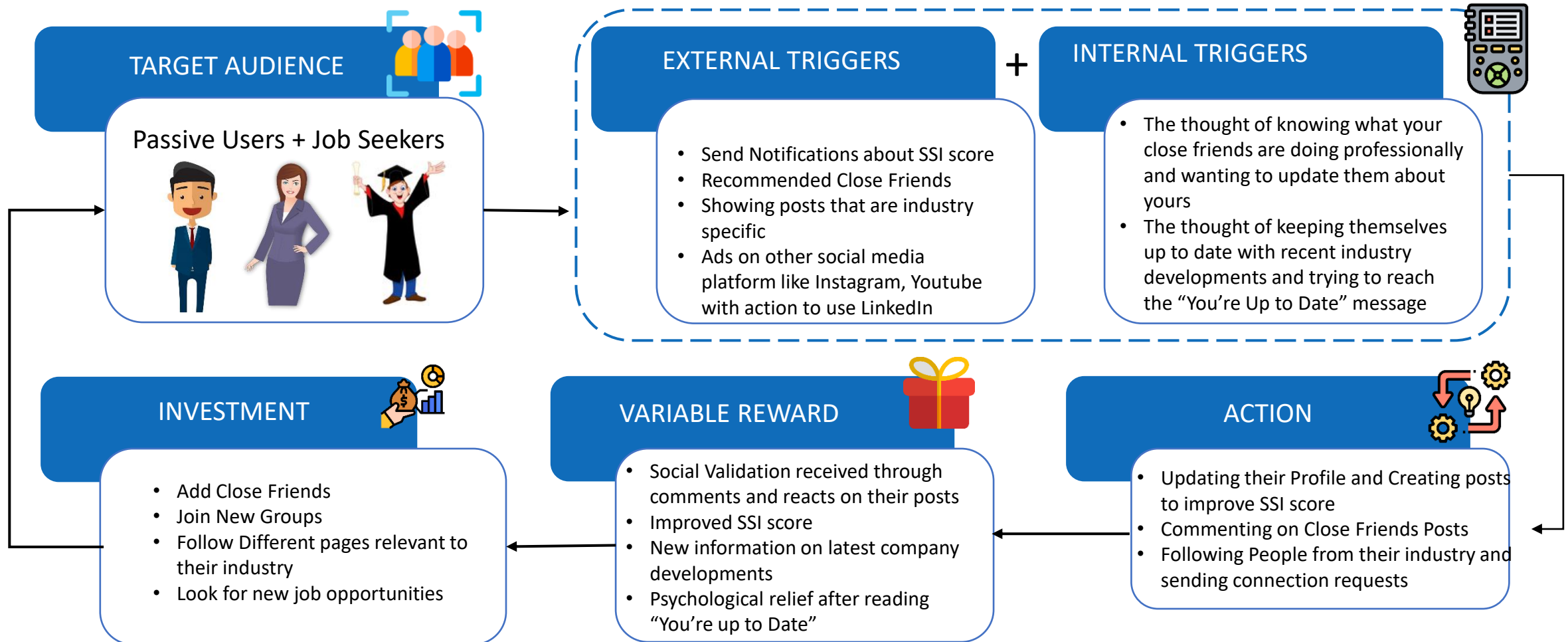
	 ACTIVE USERS	 PASSIVE USERS	 INFLUENCERS	 NO SHOWS
USE CASES	Uses resume builders, searches jobs, coordinates with friends, creates content and shares posts, uses learning to gain new skills, networks with people, keeps tab on SSI score	Views others' posts, tries to increase their network by sending connection request, checks the notification tab to find out what has been happening on his profile or new job alerts	Shares, Writes their own content and their firm's content, Has formed community with people from all walks of life, hosts webinar with their community often on LinkedIn	Literally uses none of the features that are available on the website, hardly knows what all features are present in the application/website.
EXAMPLES	- Student looking for intern/ job - HR professional looking to hire - Working professional trying to switch - Final year student building CV - College fest organisers	- MBA student looking to grow his network and interact - New addition to the network who is figuring out LinkedIn - Job Seekers who come with an end goal to find a job	- Motivational Coach trying to reach out to maximum people - C-Suite executives, founders like Elon Musk etc - Professors/ Certified trainers who post training content	- The casual user who is present just because his friends are - The one who came to LinkedIn for visibility - Users who read random content on LinkedIn and like it
PAINPOINTS	- Not able to search jobs with other filters - Lacks privacy when he posts on LinkedIn - Too much notifications	- Doesn't know how to use the app - Needs to know how to increase his network and grow SSI - Too many notifications	- Posts not reaching more people - Not able to find another influencer's post once lost - Users blocking his posts - Plagiarising his content	- Unwanted ads and sponsored messages - Finds no motivation to stay on the platform - Doesn't translate content
MOTIVATION TO USE	- Usage can be both personal and professional - Incentive, Growth, Social presence are some motivators	- Student looking for intern/ job - Job Seekers looking for a new job or a switch - Peer pressure, Social presence	- Get more people to view their posts - Incentive, Growth, Social presence, Power are motivators	- Just look at how LinkedIn works and see their friends - Fear of missing out is the only motivator for this category
GOALS	- Value seeker - Uses for personal benefit - Aims to get career progress	- Increase visibility among friends - Look at some interesting content - Learn something new	- Get their content showed to more people - Monetise his popularity	- Has no particular aim on LinkedIn - Does not want any FOMO



Problem Definition: Job Seekers come with an end goal to find a job. Once done, they believe do not have any use for the platform. This consists of a large cohort and if converted to a permanent Engagement User will improve app engagement and help meet our objective

Goal: Convert Passive Users/Job Seekers to Active Users/Permanent Engagement User

Hypothesis: Using the below displayed Hooked Model, Passive Users/Job seekers can be turned Active by introducing gamification through SSI, Close Friends Feature, Improving Job Search Experience, and Providing Psychological of being up to date with latest developments



Note: The features mentioned in the model above will be explained in detail in the slides to come

Primary and
Secondary
Research

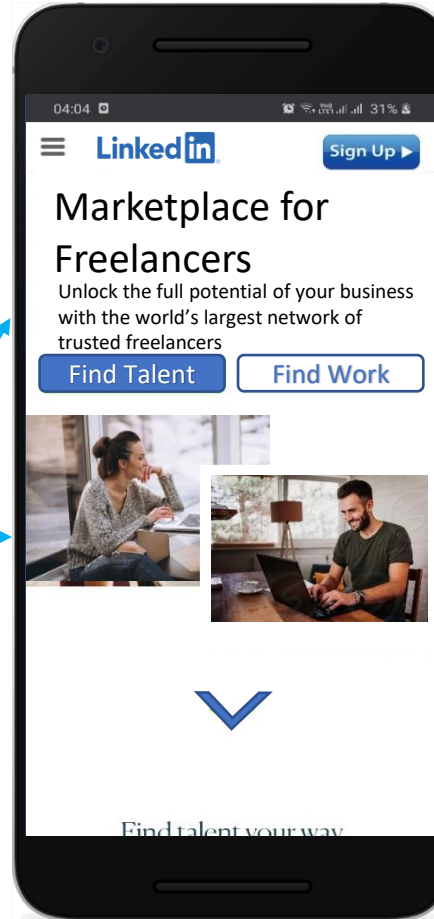
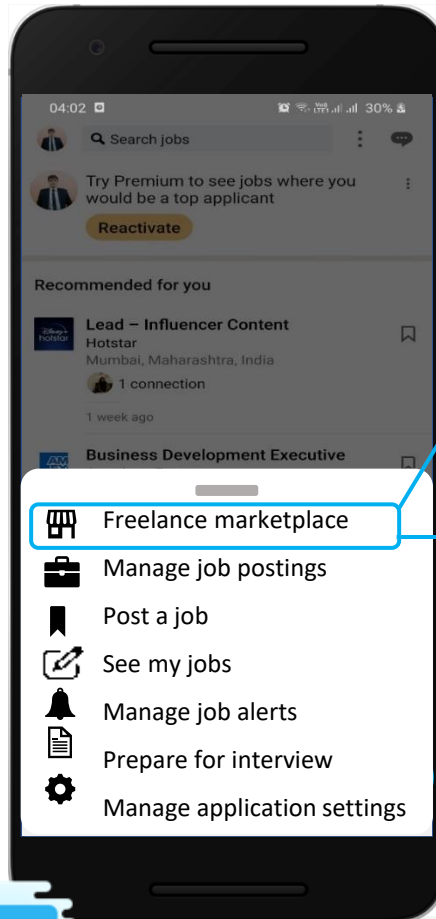
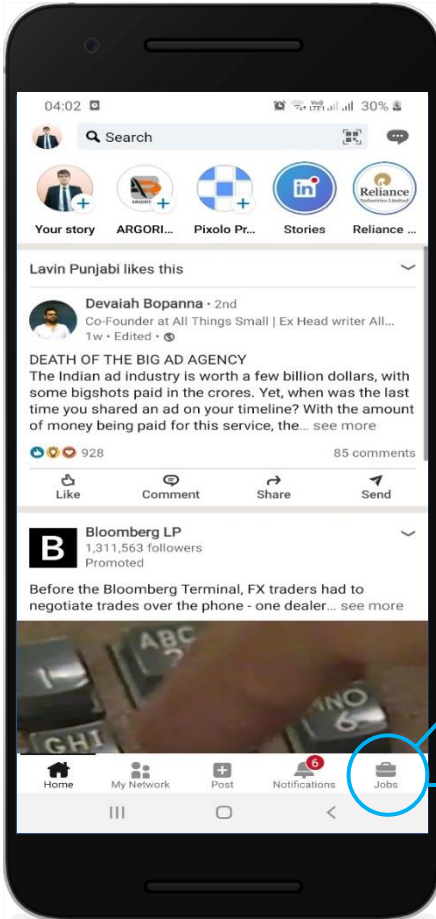
User Personas

Approach to
problem

Features

User stories

Prioritization of
features



Feature: Freelance Market Place where companies or enterprises or users with specific requirements can connect with individuals to conduct business

Insight: The pandemic has led to an increase in demand for freelance workers. There is a seismic growth towards remote working and flexible working hours which is vital at promoting the freelance culture

User Value Proposition: Freelancers can find new projects which is a source of revenue for them. Users can find freelancers and also post their own proposals to attract freelancers for specific jobs

Case in Point: In quarter, Q2 2020, Upwork reported revenues just below \$90 million USD, which was more than 10% higher than the company or analysts forecasted. Q1 2020 revenues were approximately \$83 million USD, a 5% increase. Q4 2019 revenues were around \$80 million USD, so without doubt Upwork continues to grow.

Success Metrics: Return on Investment for users, Customer acquisition cost, Retention rate, Churn rate, Stickiness, Daily/Monthly active users, Session duration, Lifetime to date, Customer Lifetime Value, ARPU, Month-on-Month growth



LinkedIn Value Proposition:

- The Freelance Marketplace has the potential to grow LinkedIn's user base and the time spent by users on the platform will also increase as more people would want to browse new opportunities
- Higher revenue through increased user base Eg: Higher Number of users will improve ad revenue and more people will now subscribe to learning courses on linkedin
- New Revenue Stream: LinkedIn can charge a particular % of the transaction amount done on its platform

Primary and
Secondary
Research

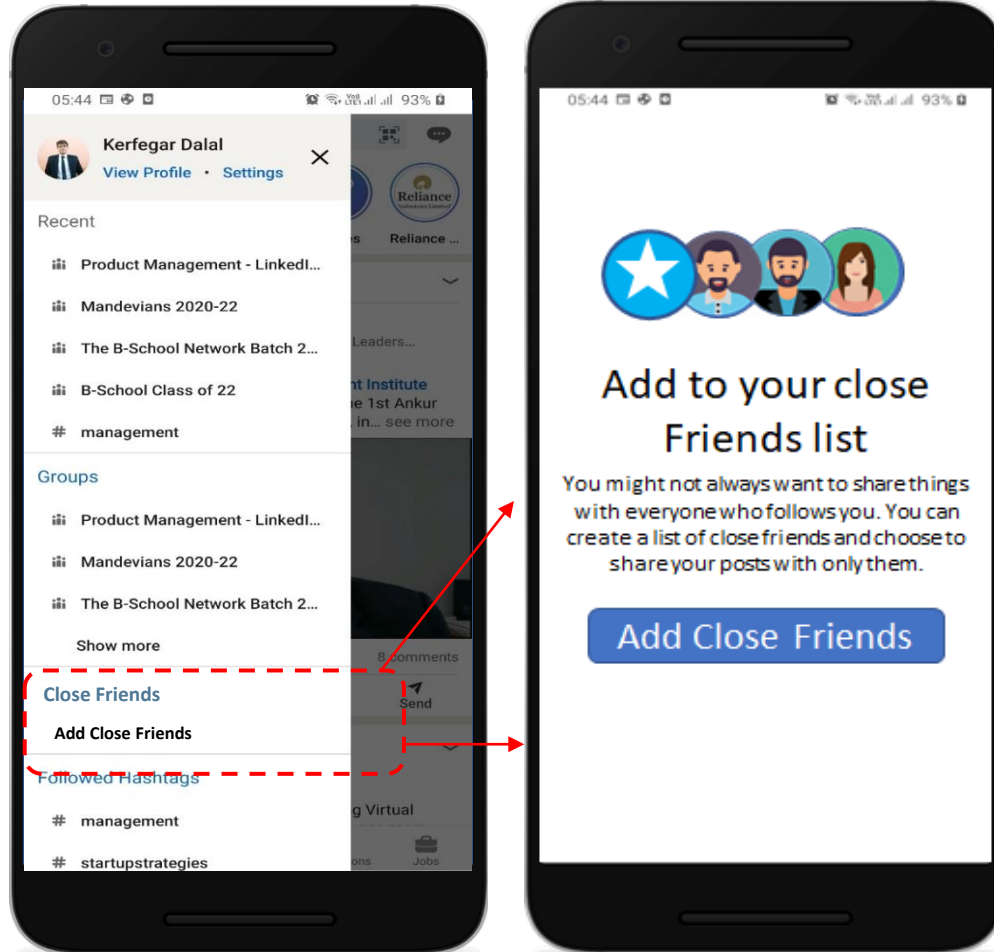
User Personas

Approach to
problem

Features

User stories

Prioritization of
features



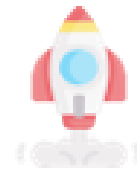
Feature: Add Close Friends and have the feature of sharing posts only with them



Insight: To grow one's network users often tend to add as many individuals as possible to their network whom they might have even the slightest of knowledge. As a result of this users are not comfortable sharing their posts with everyone in their network.



User Value Proposition: More control over who gets to see their posts. Since now they can choose to pass on information to a limited number of individuals users might feel more comfortable sharing. A separate carved out space for actual friends to remain in touch is created



Success Metrics: Reduction in churn rate, Click Through Rate, Number of posts shared



LinkedIn Value Proposition: Improved User engagement. A new friend list on LinkedIn with whom separate content can be shared will help drive user engagement. Users added to a friend's "Close Friends" list will feel privileged and thus engage more with a Close friend's posts, driving engagement

Primary and
Secondary
Research

User Personas

Approach to
problem

Features

User stories

Prioritization of
features



Feature: Users can filter jobs on the basis of Years of experience needed, salary requirements, an option to work from home



Insight: Job seekers usually have a preconceived set of requirements before they start looking for a job. These requirements go beyond the basic requirements of Skill Set, Job Title and Location



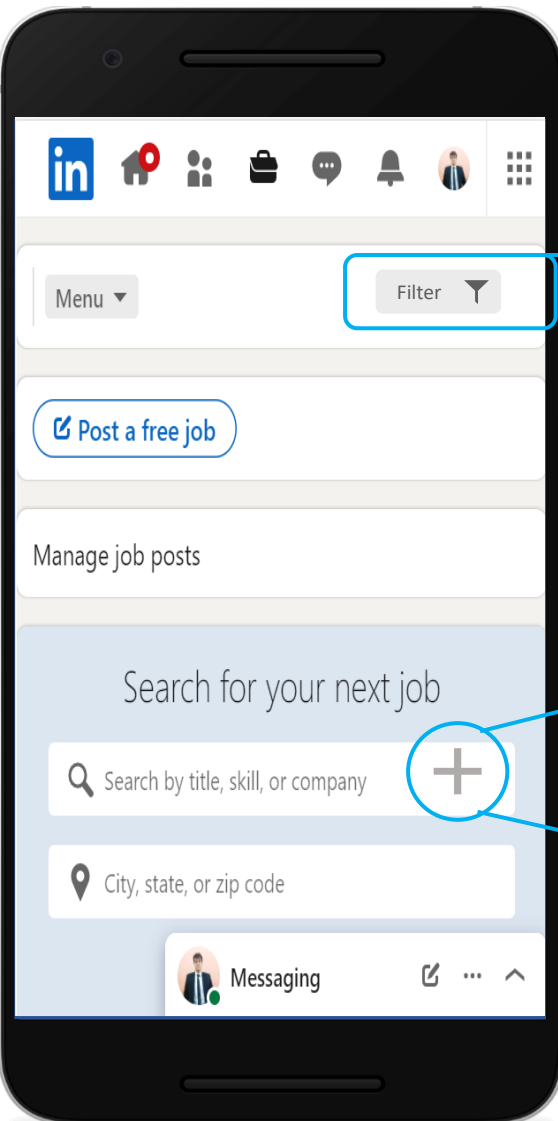
User Value Proposition: Having additional filters will help users sort and find jobs faster. Their experience of finding jobs is made easier



Success Metrics: Filters applied during job searches, session time, click through rate, retention rate, month on month growth, daily and monthly active users



LinkedIn Value Proposition: An improved user experience will help improve engagement. Improved user experience will increase the favourable mentions and higher awareness through word of mouth



Years of Experience
Salary
Work from home

Users can now select multiple job titles or skills together under a single search

Primary and
Secondary
Research

User Personas

Approach to
problem

Features

User stories

Prioritization of
features



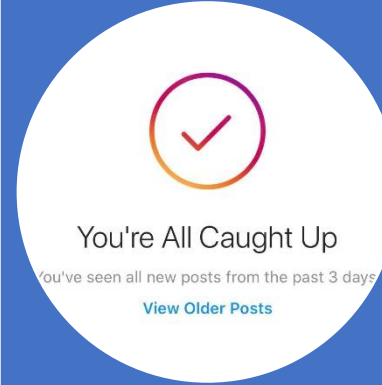
SSI Score on the Profile Page: This will help introduce an element of gamification. Users will then try and improve score through higher engagement



Dark Theme: Many Users find it visually appealing. Dark theme also saves Energy



Sort by recent posts: An Option for sorting posts which are most recent should be added to the homepage. This helps improve navigation and reduces bounce rate



"You're up to Date": This feature should be added to help job seekers know they have read all the new job listings. This will make users scroll to the point where they see this message

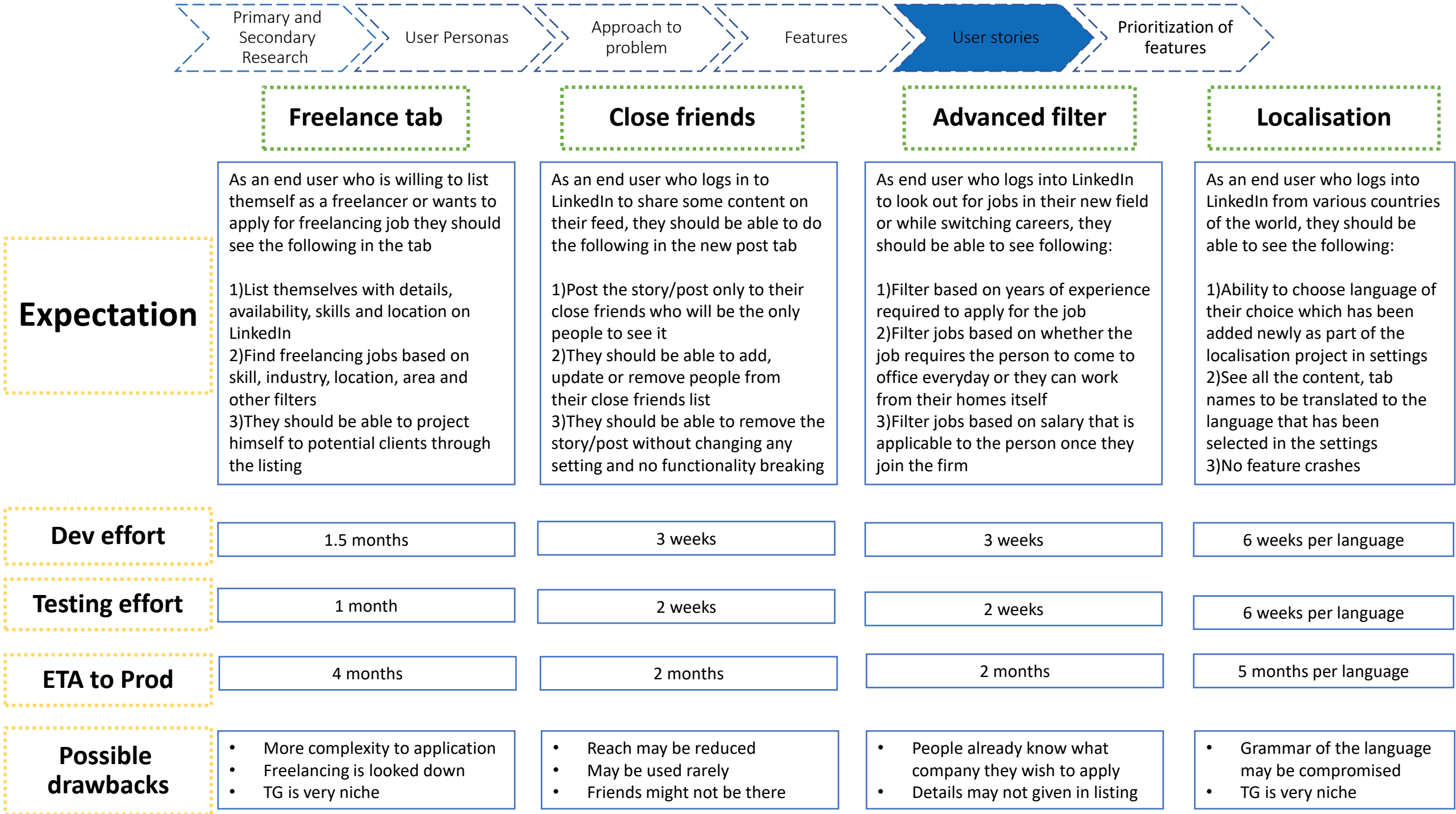


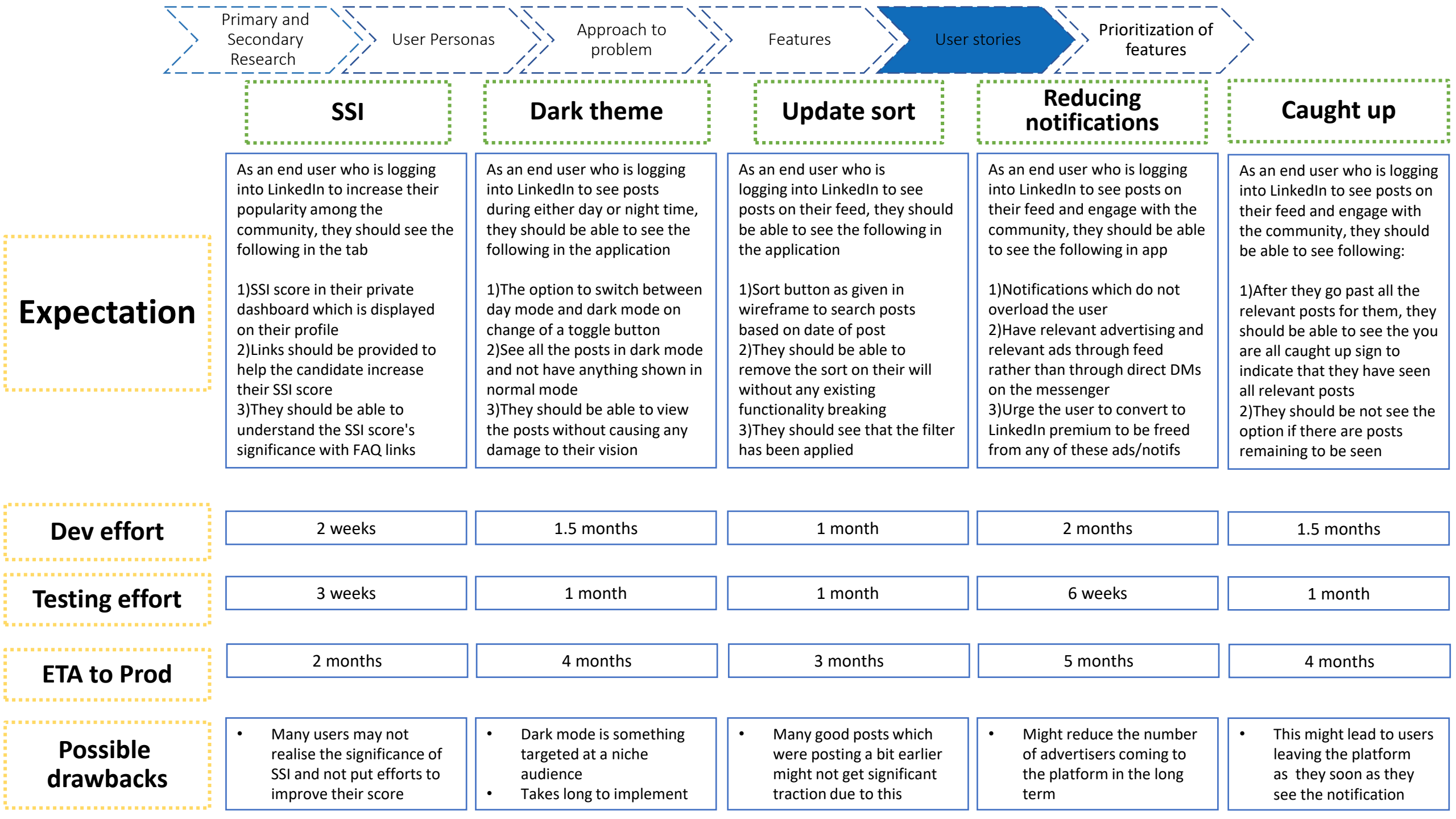
Reduce number of notifications: Primary and Secondary research tells us that due to too many notifications users tend to completely switch off notifications from the app



Localisation: Improved localisation especially in a country like India will help gain higher acceptance of the app in the country

Small Fixes to help improve user engagement along with the features recommended before







	Impact on profit	Ease of Implementation	Ease of business with TG	Confidence	Priority
Weights	0.3	0.3	0.2	0.1	-
Freelance tab	4	2.5	4	3	2
Close friends	2	4	3	4	3
Advanced filter	3	4	4	3	1
Localisation	3	1	4	2	6
SSI on profile	1	5	1	4	4
Dark Theme	2	2	2	4	7
Enhanced sort	1.5	3	3	4	5
Caught up	1	3	1	3	8
Reduce notifications	0.5	2	3	1	9

Advanced filter start
Freelance start
Close friends start

SSI start
Enhanced sort

Localisation start
Dark theme start

Caught up start

Reduce notifs start

All features
Completed and
Moved to prod

T=0

T=2

T=4

T=5

T=6

*Time measured in months

T=11



THANK YOU